

Karen Bao

Senior product designer with 9 years of experience in fintech and startups

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Experience

Sr. Product Designer @ Keep Technologies Corp. Toronto, Canada

Dec 2024 - Sep 2026

Keep Mobile: Led end-to-end design of Keep's first mobile app and design guidelines, launching in 4 months. Within 6 weeks, ~23% of businesses had at least one user log in.

Keep Travel: Designed and launched Keep's first flight booking platform with reward-point redemption, reaching \$1M in bookings within 10 months.

Card Experience: Revamped flagship credit card management and navigation to improve feature findability.

Product Research: Led NPS benchmarking, Keep Banking feature survey, and accounting integration interviews to inform roadmap priorities.

Design Practice: Created Keep's product designer competency matrix; led resource planning and weekly design reviews; mentored a designer through the Keep Bank Feed launch.

Sr. Product Designer @ RBCx Vancouver, Canada

Jul 2021 - Aug 2024

Sr. Product Designer, Mydoh (Dec 2022 - Aug 2024)

Mentored 2 designers and ran design reviews and capacity planning for the team.

Child Home Refresh: Redesigned the child app's Home tab, increasing key feature engagement by ~9%.

Earn Redesign: Redesigned chore creation and management; all 10 participants completed core tasks unassisted in usability testing.

App Usability Benchmark: Established usability benchmarks with Research to prioritize roadmap improvements.

Sr. Product Designer, Dr.Bill (Jul 2021 - Dec 2022)

First designer on the product. Partnered with Product and Research to define user segments, journey maps, and end-to-end workflows, to guide product discovery.

Sr. Product Designer @ Flybits Inc. Toronto, Canada

Nov 2019 - Jul 2021

Designed a B2B2C personalization platform for financial institutions including Mastercard, Visa, and TD Bank. Streamlined white-label content templates for pilot credit card and consumer banking experiences.

UX/UI Designer @ FreshWorks Studio (EY Design Studio) Victoria, Canada

Feb 2018 - Aug 2019

Designed digital products with cross-functional teams for clients including Harbour Air, Hootsuite, and the BC Government.

Intern, UX Designer @ SAP Canada Inc. Montreal, Canada

Oct 2016 - Apr 2017

Supported design of the Retail Assortment Planning web app.

About

I'm a product designer focused on fintech and startups, working from research and requirements definition through design and validation.

I use systems thinking to turn complex business rules and user needs into clear experiences, while strengthening design systems and team practices.

Education

Master of Digital Media

The Centre for Digital Media @
Simon Fraser University
2015 - 2017

B.A. in Advertising

Shanghai International Studies
University
2011 - 2015

Skills

Discovery & validation

User research · Survey design ·
Usability testing · Product analytics

Product design

Information architecture · Interaction
design · Prototyping · UX copywriting

Design systems

Design tokens · Component
architecture · Documentation ·
Design-to-code handoff

AI-assisted workflows

Research synthesis · Design
exploration · Rapid prototyping ·
Component structure &
documentation

Tools

Figma · Framer · Claude Code · Figma
MCP · Visual Studio Code · Metabase
· Amplitude · Typeform